

including pre-ordering of duty-free goods and food delivery at the gate. AI-enabled systems and smart lanes with automated tray returns promise to change the checkpoint experience. With machine learning scanning for threats, passengers would glide through without the usual stress or long waits.

In the north, the NIA at Jewar in UP is expected to cater to passengers living in NCR and cities in Uttar Pradesh. It is being developed by the UP government and the Swiss giant Zurich AG.

NIA is also planning technology upgrades such as smart counters to recognise passengers instantly through DigiYatra-compatible biometric systems, while AI-powered kiosks are expected to handle baggage drops and print tags in seconds. The systems will track real-time passenger flow to dynamically adjust lighting, air conditioning, and manpower at service counters.

Internationally, the biggest airports are upgrading technology to enhance customer experience. Dubai, one of the busiest in the world, is testing new scanners and AI technologies that eliminate the need for passengers to remove items such as laptops, perfumes, creams, and liquids over 100ml during security checks, which is expected to reduce the time taken by security checks.

74 | The Hamad International Airport, Doha, has introduced a digital twin through a simple 3D interface that controls aircraft stand conflicts, facilitates quick reactions to notifications, and keeps an eye on the condition of vital airport infrastructure.

Apart from this, the authorities plan to connect NIA and NMIA with modern urban transport systems, good quality road infrastructure, hotels and other facilities. “The announcement of this upcoming airport has already triggered a substantial rise in property values

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across key areas in the vicinity. This greenfield airport will further accelerate the growth, driving sustained demand and significant price appreciation, presenting lucrative long-term investment opportunities,” says Vimal Nadar, National Director & Head of Research, Colliers India.

Airports have always been big drivers of urban development. Both these airports mark a pivotal transformation in the real estate landscape of the regions. The development of NIA has already triggered a real estate boom in Yamuna Expressway, Noida Extension, Greater Noida and Jewar.

Several major airports—including in Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru, and Delhi—are planning capacity upgrades alongside the greenfield facilities. The government is also getting ready to offer 11 more airports under the PPP model with a new provision limiting each operator to two airports.

A GLOBAL HUB

The ongoing expansion of aviation infrastructure is driven by India’s larger ambition to become a global aviation hub in the coming years. Domestic airlines are planning to add around 1,500 new aircraft and are aggressively reworking their route networks and tar-